17.9 Hydrocephalus and VP Shunt

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Head circumference growing • Fontanelle bulging • Eyes looking down ("sunset eyes")	**ACTUAL** **Decreased intracranial adaptive capacity** related to accumulation of CSF as evidenced by enlarging head and bulging fontanelle.	No signs of raised ICP after the shunt.	• Measure head circumference every day. • After surgery, position the baby as ordered. • Watch for vomiting, irritability and a tense fontanelle.	Stable: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother asks • "Will my baby be normal?" **Objective** • Parents anxious • Lots of questions about the future	**ACTUAL** **Anxiety (parent)** related to infant's condition and surgery as evidenced by worry.	Parents show they understand the shunt and the plan.	• Explain how the shunt works and the signs that it is not working. • Encourage them to join in with care. • Refer to support services.	Understand: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Shunt implanted	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: implanted shunt.	Shunt stays free of infection.	• Watch the wound and the temperature. • Teach the parents the signs of infection and blockage: vomiting, irritability, bulging fontanelle. • Aseptic wound care.	No infection: **goal met**.